

following command:

```
#smartctl -H /dev/sda
```

```
smartctl 5.40 2010-10-16 r3189 [i686-pc-linux-gnu] (SUSE
RPM)
```

```
Copyright (C) 2002-10 by Bruce Allen, http://smartmontools.
sourceforge.net
```

```
=== START OF READ SMART DATA SECTION ===
```

```
SMART overall-health self-assessment test result: PASSED
Please note the following marginal Attributes:
```

ID#	ATTRIBUTE_NAME	FLAG	VALUE	WORST	THRESH
TYPE	UPDATED	WHEN_FAILED	RAW_VALUE		

190	Airflow_Temperature_Cel	0x0022	060	036	045
Old_age	Always	In_the_past	40	(Min/Max	29/44)

—Somasree Mal,
somasreemal@yahoo.co.in

Display information about an installed RPM package

This tip is for those who use an RPM based distro. We often want more information about an installed package. On RPM based GNU/Linux distros, we can get exhaustive information about installed packages using the 'rpm -qi' command, where option -q stands for 'query' and option -i stands for 'information'. Let us find out more about the GNU/Screen package.

```
[bash]$ rpm -qa | grep -i screen
```

```
screen-4.0.3-16.el6.x86_64
```

```
[bash]$ rpm -qi screen-4.0.3-16.el6.x86_64
```

```
Name      : screen                      Relocations:
(not relocatable)
Version   : 4.0.3                      Vendor:
Red Hat, Inc.
Release   : 16.el6                     Build Date:
Tue 25 Jan 2011 03:05:18 PM IST
Install Date: Fri 10 Jan 2014 02:17:31 PM IST   Build
Host: x86_009.build.bos.redhat.com
Group     : Applications/System         Source RPM:
screen-4.0.3-16.el6.src.rpm
Size      : 814092                      License:
GPLv2+
Signature : RSA/8, Fri 25 Mar 2011 11:55:32 AM IST, Key
ID 199e2f91fd431d51
Packager  : Red Hat, Inc. <http://bugzilla.redhat.com/
bugzilla>
```

URL : http://www.gnu.org/software/screen
Summary : A screen manager that supports multiple
logins on one terminal

The *screen* utility allows you to have multiple logins on just one terminal. *Screen* is useful for users who telnet into a machine or are connected via a dumb terminal, but want to use more than just one login.

—Narendra Kangralkar,
narendrakangralkar@gmail.com

Disable the root SSH login

For security reasons, you might need to disable the 'root' user SSH login for the Linux system. This can be easily done by editing the *sshd_config* file as the 'root' user. First, open up the file in any text editor:

```
vi /etc/ssh/sshd_config
```

Next, find the following line:

```
#PermitRootLogin no
```

The line is currently commented. Uncomment it, and that's all you need to do. Save the file, and restart the *ssh* service.

```
/etc/init.d/sshd restart
```

—Manit Singh Kalsi,
manit.kalsi@gmail.com

Hide a command from history

The 'history' command is used to show the list of all commands executed in the terminal. If you want to exclude a particular command from the history of the terminal, you need to type <space> and then enter the following command:

```
root@sitrc-OptiPlex-390:~# ls
```

In this command, there is a space before the 'ls' command. After this executes, type 'history'. You will not find the 'ls' command in it!

—Tushar B Kute,
tushar@tusharkute.com

END

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The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.opensourceforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.